

1. Impro is a handbook for running a cult

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 19 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/impro/>

Here's the big idea in Keith Johnstone's book Impro : Children are naturally creative, but are violently formed into repressed adults by Western culture and education The process of becoming more creative and expressive is largely a process of unlearning these habits of repression Improv ? improvisational comedy ? is thus not just the skeleton key for learning to act, but for unlocking a more authentically human way of life This take doesn't sound particularly original, but references to Impro pop up in all kinds of places: in influential tech blogs , as part of the initial process of onboarding for Palantir, and on the reading list of multiple big-tech founders . Impro is part of the secret canon of Silicon Valley, right alongside books like Seeing Like a State and The Power Broker . Why is that? For two reasons: first, because Johnstone's outsider critique of established institutions is appealing; and second, because Impro is a handbook for running a cult. Defense mechanisms and status The part of Impro that is most obviously useful to software engineers is Johnstone's chapter on status. According to him, status games pervade all social interactions. Even innocuous, friendly con...

2. Claude Code uses Bun written in Rust now

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-19T03:54:09+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/19/claude-code-in-bun-in-rust/#atom-everything>

In Rewriting Bun in Rust Jarred Sumner made the following claim: Claude Code v2.1.181 (released June 17th) and later use the Rust port of Bun. Startup got 10% faster on Linux but otherwise, barely anyone noticed. Boring is good. I decided to have a poke at my own Claude Code installation to see if I could find evidence that it was using Bun written in Rust. I found these two commands convincing: `strings ~/.local/bin/claude | grep -m1 'Bun v1'` For me this outputs `Bun v1.4.0 (macOS arm64)` . The most recent release of Bun on GitHub is currently v1.3.14 from May 12th, so that v1.4.0 version number in Claude supports them shipping a preview of a not-yet-released Bun version. `strings ~/.local/bin/claude | grep -Eo 'src/[[:alnum:]]_[-]+\rs'` This outputs a list of 563 filenames , starting with these: `src/runtime/bake/dev_server/mod.rs src/runtime/bake/production.rs src/bundler/bundle_v2.rs` It looks like Bun in Rust is indeed being run in production across millions of different devices. Like Jarred said, "Boring is good". Tags: bun , rust , anthropic , claude-code , jarred-sumner

3. SQLite Query Explainer

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-18T17:19:10+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/18/sqlite-query-explainer/#atom-everything>

Tool: SQLite Query Explainer Julia Evan's, in Learning a few things about running SQLite : Maybe one day I'll learn to read a query plan. Big same.... which inspired me to have Fable build this interactive explain tool, which runs SQLite in Python in Pyodide in Web Assembly in the browser and adds a layer of explanation to the results of both EXPLAIN and EXPLAIN QUERY PLAN. Approach with caution, since I don't know enough about SQLite query plans to verify the results myself, but it seems cromulent enough to me. Tags: sql , sqlite , tools , julia-evans , pyodide , claude-mythos-fable

4. Claude make Fable 5 permanent

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-18T06:00:13+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/18/claude-make-fable-5-permanent/#atom-everything>

Claude make Fable 5 permanent An update from the @claudeai account on Twitter: Beginning July 20, Claude Fable 5 will be included in all Max and Team Premium plans, at 50% of limits. Pro and Team Standard users will continue to have access to Fable via usage credits, and will receive a one-time \$100 credit. As I was saying last week , the competition from GPT-5.6 Sol (and maybe to a lesser extent Kimi 3) made untenable Anthropic's plan to remove Fable 5 from

their subscription accounts and make it available exclusively through API pricing. Why pay \$100 or \$200/month for a subscription plan that doesn't include Anthropic's best model? Their original plan was driven by concerns over compute capacity. I wonder if they'll have to dial back their training efforts in order to make more GPUs available to help serve the model. A lot of people were losing sleep over trying to make the most of Fable 5 before subscriber access was withdrawn. It's nice not to have to worry about the Fablepocalypse any more. Update : Important to note that users on the \$20/month plan will still not have access to Fable 5 on that subscription. The Max plans are \$100 and \$200/month. Tags: ai , generative-ai , I...

5. ? Mornings in Cupertino Have the Aroma of Napalm Once Again

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-19T00:38:17Z

Link:

https://daringfireball.net/2026/07/mornings_in_cupertino_have_the_aroma_of_napalm_once_again

I think maybe John Ternus is more of a ?*Hey, what* would *Steve have done here?*? kind of guy. What would Steve Jobs do with this OpenAI situation? He'd go to war.

6. Apple Sends Letters to Dozens of Former Employees Now at OpenAI

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-18T22:47:59Z

Link: <https://www.ft.com/content/1b8c9d52-88a9-426b-ba47-f1811f859166?syn-25a6b1a6=1>

Michael Acton, reporting for the Financial Times from San Francisco: About 40 former employees now working at OpenAI have been sent letters directing them to preserve documents and communications and demanding meetings with Apple's lawyers, according to multiple people familiar with the matter. Apple and OpenAI declined to comment. The decision to hit employees with personal legal letters highlights Apple's aggressive tactics after it last week launched a blockbuster lawsuit accusing OpenAI and two employees of stealing secret hardware plans. ?

7. Apple Raises Prices for Apple Music and Apple One Subscriptions

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T21:08:39Z

Link:

<https://9to5mac.com/2026/07/17/apple-raises-prices-for-apple-music-and-apple-one-subscriptions/>

Chance Miller, 9to5Mac: Here are the new monthly prices for Apple Music and Apple One as of today: Apple Music: Individual: \$11.99 (up from \$10.99) Family: \$19.99 (up from \$16.99) Student: \$6.99 (up from \$5.99) Apple One: Individual: \$19.95 (unchanged) Family: \$27.95 (up from \$25.95) Premier: \$39.95 (up from \$37.95) ?

8. Book Review: A City on Mars - by Dr. Kelly Weinersmith and Zach Weinersmith ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sat, 18 Jul 2026 11:34:18 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/book-review-a-city-on-mars-by-dr-kelly-weinersmith-and-zach-weinersmith/>

I'm pretty sure this book is a psyop designed to demoralise a generation of starry-eyed dreamers. It is obviously written by the same people who told us not to land on Europa. A malignant energy designed to limit the scope of human ambition and thwart our plans to colonise the universe. The problem is, I can't find fault with any of their logic. The Weinersmiths make a compelling case that?

9. Gadget Review: Thermal Master DV2 - Infrared Birdwatching Scope ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 16 Jul 2026 11:34:50 +0000

Link:

<https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/gadget-review-thermal-master-dv2-infrared-birdwatching-scope/>

The good folks at Thermal Master have sent me their DV2 camera to review. As their name suggests, this is a thermal / infrared camera - they've specifically designed this for bird watching and animal spotting. Let's put it through its paces and see how it compares to the competition! Straight away you can see it is different from normal IR cameras - they tend to have a small fixed screen and a ?

10. This Week in Package Management: 18 July 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-18T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/18/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week nine of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases pnpm 11.13 adds pnpm change , a native changesets-compatible release planner that handles version bumping, dependent propagation, fixed groups and per-package release lanes. It also adds pnpm team for registry organisation and team membership, and a versioning.epics config that ties a group of packages to a lead package so their versions stay within a band derived from the lead's major. 11.12 preceded it, letting a pnpmfile fetcher return { delegate: } so custom fetchers can hand off to the built-in ones portably across pnpm and paquet. Deno 2.9.3 adds deno add --no-save and --save-optional , and --min-dep-age as a shorter alias for the minimum-release-age check. pixi 0.73.0 lets { workspace = true } work in environment [dependencies] tables, so a version shared across features or targets is declared once in [workspace.dependencies] without needing the pixi-build preview. uv 0.11.29 adds JSON output to uv tree and prefers local artifacts over URLs when installing from pylock.toml . Verdaccio 6.8.0 fires the notification webhook on unpublish and...

11. Reading List 07/18/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 18 Jul 2026 12:01:57 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-071826>

A setback for California Forever, a \$500 million artillery shell plant not producing any shells, the difficulty of recycling EV batteries, manufacturing wire harnesses, and more.

12. What's the deal with all the random weekly quota resets for agents lately?

Source: Max Woolf's Blog | Published: Sat, 18 Jul 2026 12:00:00 -0700

Link: <https://minimaxir.com/2026/07/agent-quota-reset/>

I'm going to be the weirdo who complains about literally getting free stuff.

13. Make It Work vs. Make It Good

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Sat, 18 Jul 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/make-it-work-make-it-good/>

There are two wolves inside of me, lol. Some days I want to be a ?designer?. Other days I want to be a ?developer?. On the days I find myself wanting to feed the developer, it's often because making something ?work? seems easier (and more impressive) than making something ?good?. Making something function often results in a reaction of ?Wow, that's so cool! It didn't work before and now it does! And I could've never made that, nice job!? And sometimes it's like, good job, you made a bear ride a unicycle . Not really what bears are supposed to do ? and they'll probably never be good at it ? but it's novel and functioning! However, the task of making something good ? of arriving at a solution that is obvious ? is often met with a kind of ambivalence, like ?Nice work?! I guess? Seems obvious tbh.? That's the work of design: to make something so good, it's obvious. But there's often little acclaim for the obvious because, well, it's so obvious (in hindsight). This plays out in many different ways. For example, consider a task like making a web site responsive. In my experience, it's often quite easy to get people to say ?Hey that's cool, it looks like a mobile site now! Good job!?. Getti...